

DAY #1

Q → How did the abolition of East India Company's trade monopoly under the charter Acts of 1813 and 1833 accelerate India's transformation from a commercial outpost to a full-fledged colony?

Ans → The charter acts of 1813 and 1833 affirmed CROWN SOVEREIGNTY over Indian territories by abolishing the monopoly of East India Company as a aftermath of Manufacturer-trader tussle in England. This affirmation paved the way for colonizing India.

India's transformation from a commercial outpost to full-fledged colony: Role of Charter Acts of 1813 & 1833

① Erosion of Commercial Monopoly —

① Charter Act of 1813 limited the monopoly to tea and China and this too was abolished with Charter act of 1833.

① This facilitated flooding of Indian market with British manufactured goods.

② Economic Subordination -

① India became the supplier of raw materials like cotton and Indigo for British industries and a market for their products.

② As per Bipin Chandra (Historian), import duty of around 2500% was put for Indian textiles.

③ End of Commercial function of Company -

① Charter act of 1833 explicitly transformed East India Company into Administrative body.

② In this way, India legally unified under one central government.

④ Centralization of Administration

① Charter Act 1833 transformed Governor General of Bengal into Governor General of India.

④ Bombay and Madras lost legislative autonomy and all legislative power centralized in Calcutta.

⑤ Legal framework for Governance -

① The Charter Acts facilitated the codification of laws like IPC, CPC and CrPc and thereby reinforcing British authority and governance structures.

⑥ Socio-economic reforms -

① Provision of 1 lakh rupee for education and scientific development, enactments such as Abolition of Sati Act (1829) etc.

① Measures to improve the condition of slaves and establishing bishoprics in Madras & Bombay expanded their presence deep into Indian society.

⑦ Opening of Civil Services -

① While initially resisted by the company's

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(Question No.)

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directors, the charter act included the provisions stating that no Indian should be barred from holding offices based on religion, place of birth, descent or color.

- ① Although the implementation was slow and discriminatory in practice, it laid the groundwork for Indian participation in the administration in later years.

The Charter Act of 1813 cracked upon the door for economic exploitation of India. The charter act of 1833 then firmly established the administrative and legal machinery for direct British rule, transforming India a commercial outpost managed for profit into a full-fledged colony governed to serve British interests.